



Mary Andrews
College

Assessment Guide



Assessment checklist

- ☐ The assessment question has been answered.
- ☐ The assessment is all your own work.
- ☐ The assessment has been proofread for spelling and grammar errors.
- ☐ It is typed and uses 1.5 spacing or double spacing.
- ☐ Each page contains at least a 3cm margin on the left-hand side for lecturer comments.
- ☐ Each page is numbered consecutively.
- ☐ It contains correctly formatted footnotes and bibliography.
- ☐ The word count is as close to the limit as possible.
- ☐ It includes a synopsis (if longer than 1500 words).
- ☐ An assessment cover sheet is attached.
- ☐ If an extension has been granted, the new (extended) due date is included in your cover sheet.
- ☐ Is saved as a PDF before submission.
- ☐ The file name is: student number, unit code, assessment number, year, semester.
- ☐ The PDF copy is submitted on Arca.

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How to Read Your Assessment Question

Read	the question twice
Identify	the instructive or directive words
Identify	the topic words
Identify	the restricting words
Consult	marking criteria
Clarify	with your lecturer

Instructive/directive words

A question mark (?): You are being asked to discuss a topic.

Account for: Give a clear explanation of something and evaluate ---..possible causes/reasons.

Analyse: Break down the topic into all of its important parts, explain

- the importance of each of these parts, definitions, or concepts and explain
- how they connect to each other.

Argue: Provide reasons for and/or against something, citing evidence.

Assess: Judge the significance/importance of something based on ...evidence.

Comment: Choose a side or provide a perspective without necessarily ...giving your own opinion, and it's advisable to check with your lecturer if ...they want your personal views.

Compare: Look for similarities and differences.

Contrast: Similar to compare but here you are emphasising the ...differences.

Define: Explain the meaning of something.

Describe: Give a detailed explanation of a topic.

Discuss: Consider a topic from various points of view with supporting ...evidence.

Explain: Give reasons or account for something so that it is easy to ...understand.

Identify: Recognise and name.

Illustrate: Make clear or explain using examples, comparisons, diagrams, ...or graphs.

Justify: Give good reasons for decisions or conclusions using supportive ...evidence.

Outline: Briefly outline the main features, facts, or general ideas about ...something.

Prove: Show that something is accurate/true/valid by using facts, ...documents, and/or other information to build your case.

Show: Explain your topic giving evidence or examples to establish a ...strong case.

Summarise: Give a brief, concise account of the main points of the topic.

Topic Words

Topic words are the key terms that indicate the main subject or focus of the question. These words help you to identify what the essay should be about and to guide your research and writing.

For example, in a question like "Discuss the significance of the resurrection in Christian theology," the topic words are

"significance," "resurrection," and "Christian theology."

Another example could be "Analyze the role of the Holy Spirit in the early church," where the topic words are **"role," "Holy Spirit," and "early church."**

Restricting Words

Restricting words are terms in an assessment question that limit the scope of your response, helping you to focus on specific aspects of a topic.

Examples of restricting words might include **"only," "specifically," "in the context of," or "with reference to."** For instance, in the question "Discuss the significance of the resurrection specifically in the context of early Christian theology," the restricting words are **"specifically" and "in the context of early Christian theology."** Recognizing these words helps you tailor your research and writing to meet the precise requirements of the assessment.

Where to Research?



Recommended Texts on Unit Bibliography
College Library Catalogue and Arca eLibrary
Perlego
EBSCO/JSTOR – Journals



Wikipedia
Youtube
ChatGPT
Blogs

A good source is...

From a respected author.
Aimed at an appropriate audience.
Has been verified/peer reviewed.
Has a relevant stance in relation to the subject.
Up to date.

How To:

AVOID PLAGIARISM

Definition: Plagiarism is presenting another person's words or thoughts as one's own without proper acknowledgment. Students must use footnotes to cite sources of extracts, quotes, and paraphrases.

Importance: Avoiding plagiarism is crucial for rigorous and honest scholarly engagement. As Christians, it is also about honoring God and adhering to biblical principles against theft and dishonesty (1 Timothy 5:18).

WHAT CONSTITUTES PLAGIARISM?

- Direct quotes without quotation marks.
- Direct quotes with footnotes but no quotation marks.
- Direct quotes with quotation marks but no footnotes.
- Borrowing ideas without acknowledgment.
- Submitting another student's work.
- Self-plagiarism: Submitting the same work for different assessments.

ACCEPTABLE USE WITHOUT CITING:

- General knowledge or widely attested information (e.g., Jerusalem's destruction in 70AD, Jesus' ministry).

CONSEQUENCES OF PLAGIARISM:

- Inadvertent Misconduct: Opportunity to resubmit with marks deducted and academic counselling.
- Deliberate Plagiarism:
 - First Offence: Academic counselling, possible failure of the assessment, or resubmission with a maximum of 50% marks.
 - Second Offence: Failure of the unit with no remedial opportunity.
 - Third/Major Offence: Possible exclusion from Australian University of Theology awards for up to two years (Ref. 5.14).

The use of AI

POLICY

The Academic Integrity Policy prohibits the use of AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT) in any assessment task, including projects or theses, with three exceptions:

1. Preliminary research, with acknowledgment of the tool used.
2. General advice on spelling and grammar (excluding explicit AI features in grammar tools like GrammarlyGO).
3. Written authorization from a lecturer for other aspects of an assessment, with full referencing.

DETECTION AND REVIEW

- Turnitin scans for AI use and alerts the lecturer.
- The lecturer informs the Education Manager, who reviews the evidence and may:
 - a) Request drafts or notes from the student.
 - b) Meet with the student to discuss their understanding and preparation of the assessment.
 - c) Make a determination and inform the student in writing.

PENALTIES

If unauthorized use is proven, the Education Manager will apply penalties as per the policy.

Essay Structure

Below is an example of an essay structure. For a more detailed explanation of each section refer to the Assessment Handbook on the college Arca.

I	<u>INTRODUCTION</u> 10–15% of essay	1. Introduce your topic 2. Introduce focus 3. Introduce essay ..structure 4. Present your thesis or key statement.
B	<u>BODY</u> 80% of essay 1 paragraph = 1 main idea Supported by evidence from research/Bible.	Each Paragraph contains: 1. Topic sentence 2. Describe 3. Analyse 4. Explain 5. Concluding sentence.
C	<u>CONCLUSION</u> 5–10% of essay	1. Draw together findings. 2. State conclusions 3. Consider implications

How to: FORMAT YOUR ASSESSMENT

All assessments should:

- Be typed (not hand-written) and use 1.5 spacing or double-spacing
- At least size 11 font and in Times New Roman, Arial or similar.
- Contain consecutively numbered pages
- Contain footnotes and a bibliography
- Be as close as possible to the required word limit.

While it is acceptable to have assessments that are 10% under or over the required word limit, you should not aim for the 10% under/over but the actual word limit given by your lecturer.

Please note: assessments that are more than 10% over the required word limit will attract a penalty of 10% off the final mark for every 10% they are over the word limit.

- Be submitted on or before the due date
- Be submitted on Arca as a pdf file. See page 25.

Please save your document using the file name: **student number, unit code, and assessment number, year and semester.**

e.g. MAC12345, DEO28-512, 1, 2025, S2.

- Students should keep a copy of all their submitted assessments.
- All assessments longer than 1,500 words require a synopsis.

Referencing Guidelines + Examples

Mary Andrews College follows the Society of Biblical Literature (SBL) referencing system commonly used in theological academia. This system is based on footnotes rather than on the author-date in-text citation methods used in other fields of tertiary study.

Quick Tips on Referencing

- **Footnotes:** Write the author's name in the correct order (e.g., N.T. Wright, *Jesus and the Victory of God*).
- **Abbreviated Version:** for all footnote citations after the first.
- **Bibliography:** Sort sources alphabetically by the author's surname (e.g., Wright, N.T. *Jesus and the Victory of God*).
- **Page Numbers:** Cite exact pages in footnotes. In the bibliography, cite page numbers only for journal articles, encyclopaedia, dictionary entries, or a chapter in an edited book.
- **Formatting:** Footnotes should be single-spaced and in 10-point font.
- **Time-Saving Tip:** Cut and paste relevant information from your unit outline.

Direct Quotes

Using Direct Quotes in Essays

Direct quotes should make up no more than 10% of your essay. This rule ensures that we see your own writing and understanding of the topic. Exceeding this limit will result in a 10% penalty for every 10% over the maximum.

Direct Quotes Include:

- Citations from secondary sources
- Quotes from the Bible

Reducing Direct Quotes:

- Instead of using a full quote, integrate only the essential part. For example, from Tremper Longman III's "How to Read Genesis":
 - **Full quote:** "The truth of the matter is that the proper interpretation of any piece of literature, and in particular a text as ancient and as important as the Bible, deserves our careful reflection."
 - **Reduced quote:** While all literature requires careful reflection, the Bible "deserves our careful reflection," according to Tremper Longman III.

Biblical Quotes:

- Summarize biblical quotes in your own words and include a citation.

For example:

- Summary: The Apostle Paul reminds us that in the Body of Christ all members work together through the Spirit (1 Cor. 12:12-13).

HOW TO CITE Book

by one author

Footnote:

D. Watson, *I Believe in the Church* (London: Hodder and Stoughton, 1982), 13.

Abbreviated version:

Watson, *I Believe in the Church*, 126.

Bibliography:

Watson, D. *I Believe in the Church*. London: Hodder and Stoughton, 1982

HOW TO CITE Book

by more than one author

Footnote:

J. M. Robinson and H. Koester, *Trajectories through Early Christianity* (Philadelphia: Fortress Press, 1971), 237.

Abbreviated version:

Robinson and Koester, *Trajectories*, 240.

Bibliography:

Robinson, J. M., and H. Koester. *Trajectories through Early Christianity*. Philadelphia: Fortress Press, 1971

HOW TO CITE

Chapter in an edited book

Footnote:

H. W. Attridge, "Jewish Historiography," in *Early Judaism and its Modern Interpreters* (ed. R. A. Kraft and G. W. E. Nickelsburg; Philadelphia: Fortress Press, 1986), 311.

Abbreviated version: Attridge, "Jewish Historiography," 315.

Bibliography:

Attridge, H. W. "Jewish Historiography." Pages 311–343 in *Early Judaism and its Modern Interpreters*. Edited by R. A. Kraft and G. W. E. Nickelsburg. Philadelphia: Fortress Press, 1986.

HOW TO CITE

Article in a journal

Please note: When you cite a journal article in your footnotes, you only need to cite the page/s you refer to in your essay. However, in your bibliography, you need to include all the pages of the journal article.

Footnote:

L. Gosbell, "Embodied Worship: Reflecting on the Inclusion of People with Disabilities in Church Communities," *Practical Theology* 12.3 (June 2019): 250.

Abbreviated version: Gosbell, "Embodied Worship," 251.

Bibliography:

Gosbell, L. "Embodied Worship: Reflecting on the Inclusion of People with Disabilities in Church Communities." *Practical Theology* 12.3 (June 2019): 250–252.

HOW TO CITE

Article

in an encyclopedia or dictionary

Important Notes on Encyclopaedia and Dictionary Citations

- Author Identification: Each section or article in an encyclopaedia or dictionary is written by different authors. Check the author's name at the end of the article, not the editor's name on the front of the book.
- Citing Pages: In footnotes, cite only the pages you refer to in your essay. In the bibliography, include all pages of the article.

Footnote: K. Stendahl, "Biblical Theology, Contemporary" in *The Interpreter's Dictionary of the Bible* (ed. G. A. Buttrick; 4 vols. Nashville: Abingdon Press, 1962), 420.

Abbreviated version: Stendahl, "Biblical Theology," 424.

Bibliography: Stendahl, K. "Biblical Theology, Contemporary." Pages 418–432 in vol. 1 of *The Interpreter's Dictionary of the Bible*. Edited by G. A. Buttrick. 4 vols. Nashville: Abingdon Press, 1962

HOW TO CITE

Internet publication without a print counterpart

Please note: This is for articles or publications you might find online but **do not** appear anywhere else, e.g. in a journal or magazine.

Please note: You must include in your citation the date that you found this article online.

Footnote:

M. T. Farrell, *"History of the Discovery of Thomas and Comments on the Text,"* (accessed 5 May 1997). <http://www.miseri.edu/davies/thomas/farrell.htm>

Abbreviated version:

Farrell, *"History of the Discovery."*

Bibliography:

Farrell, M. T. *"History of the Discovery of Thomas and Comments on the Text."* Accessed 5 May 1997.
<http://www.miseri.edu/davies/thomas/farrell.htm>

HOW TO CITE

Information on a website

Please note: You only need to include the date accessed if the website is regularly updated and content is subject to change. Eg. A blog post will not be edited however a website will often change.

Footnote:

M. Smith, "A Gross Misrepresentation of History?" Centre for Public Christianity. April 2, 2010. <https://publicchristianity.org/library/a-gross-misrepresentation-of-history>

"Beyond Blue Website," Beyond Blue, accessed November 12, 2024, <https://www.beyondblue.org.au>.

Abbreviated version:

Smith, "A Gross Misrepresentation."

"Beyond Blue Website."

Bibliography:

Smith, M. "A Gross Misrepresentation of History?" Centre for Public Christianity. April 2, 2010. <https://publicchristianity.org/library/a-gross-misrepresentation-of-history>

Beyond Blue. "Beyond Blue Website." Accessed November 12, 2024. <https://www.beyondblue.org.au>.

HOW TO CITE eBook

E.G. proquest, EBSCO

Footnote:

T. Keller, *The Reason for God: Belief in an Age of Skepticism* (New York: Riverhead Books, 2008), chap. 2, Kindle.

Alternatively, some e-books give a location instead of page numbers. In this case, you would cite:

T. Keller, *The Reason for God: Belief in an Age of Skepticism* (New York: Riverhead Books, 2008), loc. 25, Kindle.

Abbreviated version: Keller, "*Reason for God*," chap. 2.

Bibliography:

Keller, T. *The Reason for God: Belief in an Age of Skepticism*. New York: Riverhead Books, 2008. Kindle edition

HOW TO CITE eBook

on Perlego

To find a citation in Perlego, click the **99** on on the left, select "SBL" from the dropdown menu, and copy the citation. This will only give a bibliography citation.

Footnote:

Iain M. Duguid. *Ezekiel* (Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 2011), ch. 2
<https://www.perlego.com/book/559675/ezekiel-pdf>.

Abbreviated version: Duguid, *Ezekiel* ch. 3

Bibliography:

Duguid, Iain M., *Ezekiel*. Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 2011.
<https://www.perlego.com/book/559675/ezekiel-pdf>

HOW TO CITE Podcast

Footnote:

Tim Mackie and Jon Collins (hosts), "Apocalyptic Literature Part 1: Apocalypse Please." Bible Project (podcast). April 27, 2020. Accessed January 21, 2021.
<https://bibleproject.com/podcast/apocalypse-please>

Abbreviated version:

Mackie and Collins, "Apocalyptic Literature Part 1: Apocalypse Please."
<https://bibleproject.com/podcast/apocalypse-please>

Bibliography:

Mackie, Tim, and Jon Collins (hosts). "Apocalyptic Literature Part 1: Apocalypse Please." Bible Project (podcast). April 27, 2020. Accessed January 21, 2021.
<https://bibleproject.com/podcast/apocalypse-please>

HOW TO CITE Unpublished material eg. lecture notes

Footnote:

J. Stoneman, "The Spiritual Fight." Unpublished lecture notes (Mary Andrews College, 1998), 3.

Abbreviated version: Stoneman, "Spiritual Fight," 4.

Bibliography:

Stoneman, J. "The Spiritual Fight." Unpublished lecture notes. Mary Andrews College, 1998

HOW TO CITE

Online video

eg. youtube

Bible Project

Footnote:

Bible Project, "The Story of the Bible."

<https://bibleproject.com/explore/video/the-story-of-the-bible/>

Abbreviated version:

Bible Project, "The Story of the Bible."

Bibliography:

Bible Project. "The Story of the Bible."

<https://bibleproject.com/explore/video/the-story-of-the-bible/>

YouTube Clip

Footnote:

Wipf and Stock Publishers, "Trauma-Sensitive Theology: Interview with Jennifer Baldwin." <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z8RAGfBz9gk>

Abbreviated version:

Wipf and Stock Publishers, "Trauma-Sensitive Theology."

Bibliography: Wipf and Stock Publishers. "Trauma-Sensitive Theology: Interview with Jennifer Baldwin." <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z8RAGfBz9gk>

Standard Abbreviations

The following abbreviations can be used for books of the Bible in your essay but only in the footnotes and in biblical citations.

OLD TESTAMENT (OT)

Gen.	1 Sam.	Esth.	Lam.	Mic.
Exod.	2 Sam.	Job.	Ezek.	Nah.
Lev.	1 Kgs.	Ps.	Dan	Zeph.
Num.	2 Kgs.	Prov.	Hos.	Hag.
Deut.	1 Chr.	Eccl.	Joel.	Zech.
Josh.	2 Chr.	SoS.	Amos.	Mal.
Judg.	Ezra	Isa.	Obad.	
Ruth.	Neh.	Jer.	Jonah.	

NEW TESTAMENT (NT)

Matt.	1 Cor.	1 Thes.	Heb.	3 Jn.
Mk.	2 Cor.	2 Thes.	Jas.	Jude.
Lk.	Gal.	1 Tim.	1 Pet.	Rev.
Jn.	Eph.	2 Tim.	2 Pet.	
Acts.	Phil.	Tit.	1 Jn.	
Rom.	Col.	Phlm.	2 Jn.	

PERIODS OF TIME

A.D. Anno Domini (relating to the time from Jesus' birth onwards)

B.C. Before Christ (relating to the time before Jesus)

B.C.E. "Before the Common Era" (which is equivalent to B.C.)

C.E. "Common Era" (which is equivalent to A.D.)

BIBLE TRANSLATIONS

CEV Contemporary English Version

GNB Good News Bible

HCSB Holman Christian Standard Bible

KJV King James Version

MSG The Message

NASB New American Standard Bible

NIV New International Version

NKJV New King James Version

NLT New Living Translation

NRSV New Revised Standard Version

OTHER STANDARD ABBREVIATIONS

c. Circa – used to indicate approximate date e.g., “Jesus’ birth took place c. 4 B.C.”

cf. Compare with – used to compare one text to another. To be used in footnotes only.

E.g., Rom. 3:21 cf. Rom. 8:1.

E.g., this can also be used to compare the writings of scholars in a footnote: “Wright, Jesus and the Victory of God, 25 cf. Crossan, Who is Jesus? 78).”

Chap. Chapters – only to be used in footnotes.

E.g., if you want to refer to a whole chapter in a book: “This view is argued by Cross, Who is Jesus? 21–47, also chap. 2.

v. Verse

vv. Verses

E.g., “Chapter 3 of Romans focuses in particular on the righteousness of God which Paul considers to be available to all people apart from the law (v. 27) and is, therefore, available to Jews and Gentiles alike (vv. 22– 24).

How To: WRITE A SYNOPSIS

A synopsis is required for every essay that is 1,500 words or longer unless your lecturer tells you otherwise. The synopsis is not included in the word count and should be approximately 3–4 sentences in length. It should be written last after you finish the body of your essay.

Your synopsis should be on a page of its own before the essay and be clearly labelled as **Synopsis**.

A synopsis should contain the following elements:

1. Problem statement – What is the purpose of the essay, what question are you answering or what is the main argument you are addressing?
2. Approach – How did you go about solving the problem? Did you use a certain methodology?

Please note: You do not need to detail the books or steps you took in your research. Instead, provide a general overview of your approach to solving the problem.

3. Results – What were the outcomes of your research?
4. Conclusion – What did you conclude overall? What are the implications of your conclusion?

E X A M P L E

"This essay argues that despite the range of similarities and differences between the gospels of the New Testament, the key message of the gospels is the same: to encourage believers in their faith in Jesus and to make known the gospel to those who do not yet have faith in Him. This study draws on a range of sources which compare and contrast the narratives of the New Testament, in particular those sources which focus on the theory of Markan priority which asserts that Mark wrote his gospel first and that both Luke and Matthew were in possession of Mark's gospel when they wrote their own accounts."

Assessment Coversheet

Where to find?

You can find the Assessment Coversheet on the Assessment tab on your unit page.

Click the button to download the pdf form and fill in the details before saving.



**ASSESSMENT
COVERSHEET**

All assessments should include an assessment cover sheet which is a pdf file attached either at the beginning of your assessment or as a separate file. It includes the following information:

- o Your student number
- o Your unit code
- o Unit title
- o Assessment number
- o Assessment title
- o Word limit
- o Actual word count
- o Lecturer's name
- o Due date
- o Date submitted

New – AUT AI Declaration

AUT students will also need to declare any AI use.

How To: GET AN EXTENSION

Under the AUT's Extensions Policy, students may apply for an extension if special circumstances:

- Are unforeseen and/or unexpected
- Are beyond the student's control
- Make it impracticable to complete the assessment on time

SPECIAL CIRCUMSTANCES

- Medical, family, personal, employment, or study-related issues

APPLICATION PROCESS

- Submit a request via the online extension form before the due date
- Extensions are only granted if the assessment has not been submitted
- Supporting documentation is required and will be kept on file

COMPLETION

- Assessments must be completed within the granted extension period, and no later than the final due date of the semester
- For further time, apply for a Deferred Assessment

Scan to submit
an extension
request.



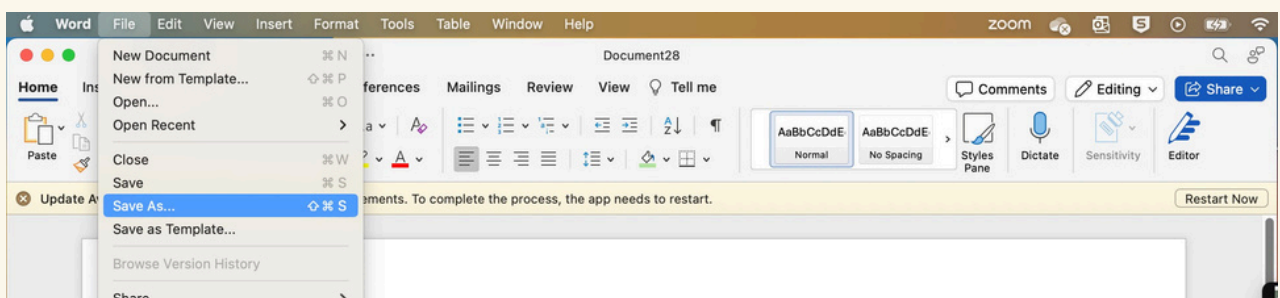
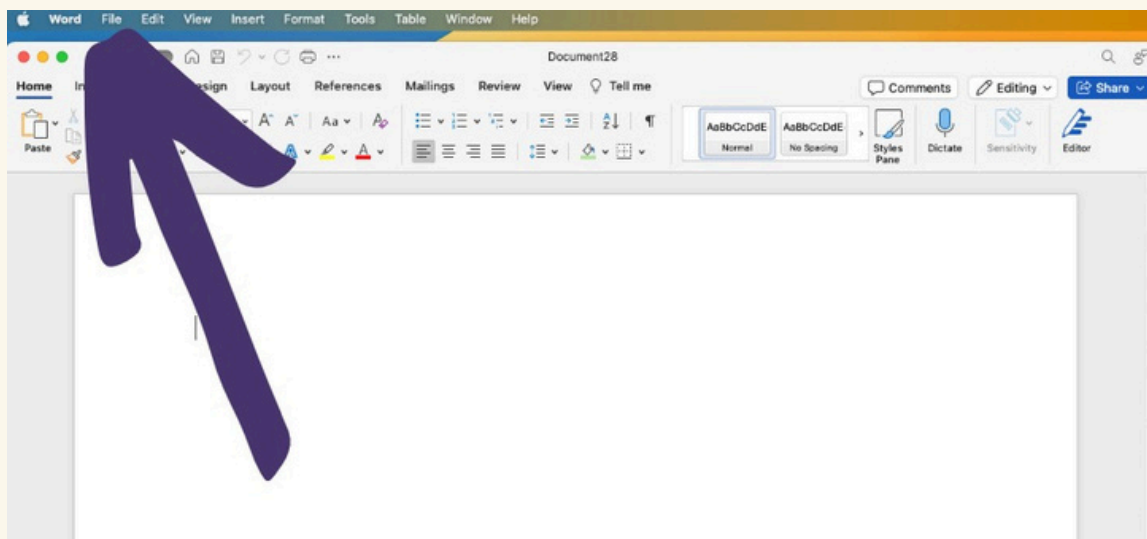
How To:

HOW TO SAVE YOUR DOCUMENT AS A PDF

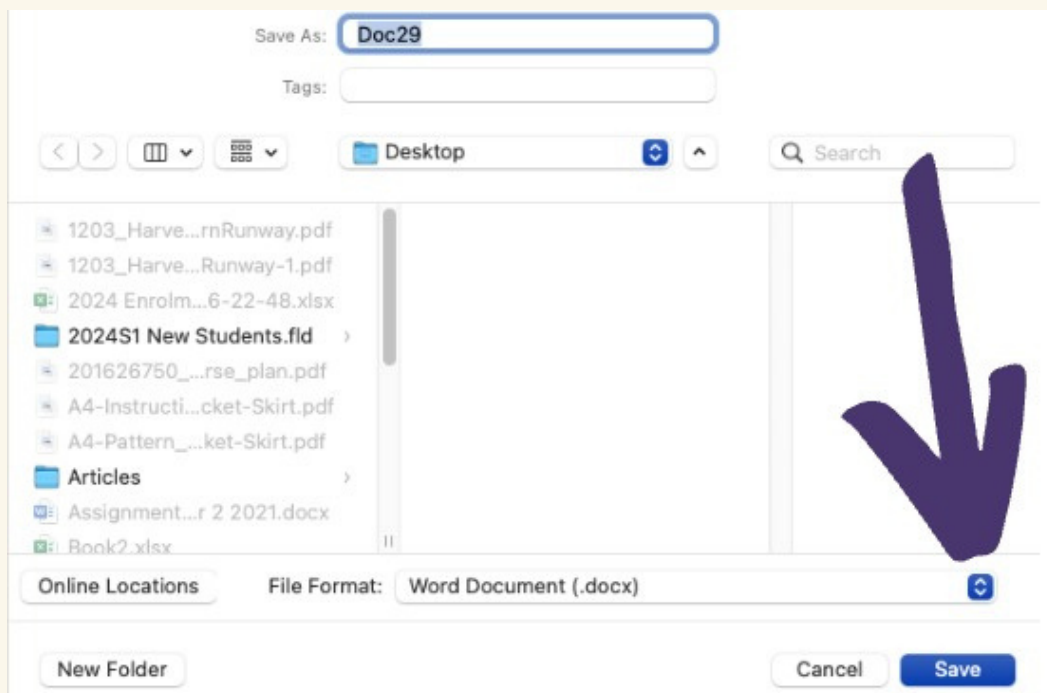
Once your assessment has been carefully formatted, you will need to save it as a PDF. Saving a document as a PDF will ensure that any formatting and layout are preserved, and can significantly reduce file size.

To save a document as a pdf,

Open your formatted document. In the top left of your computer, you should see the word 'file'. Click on that.



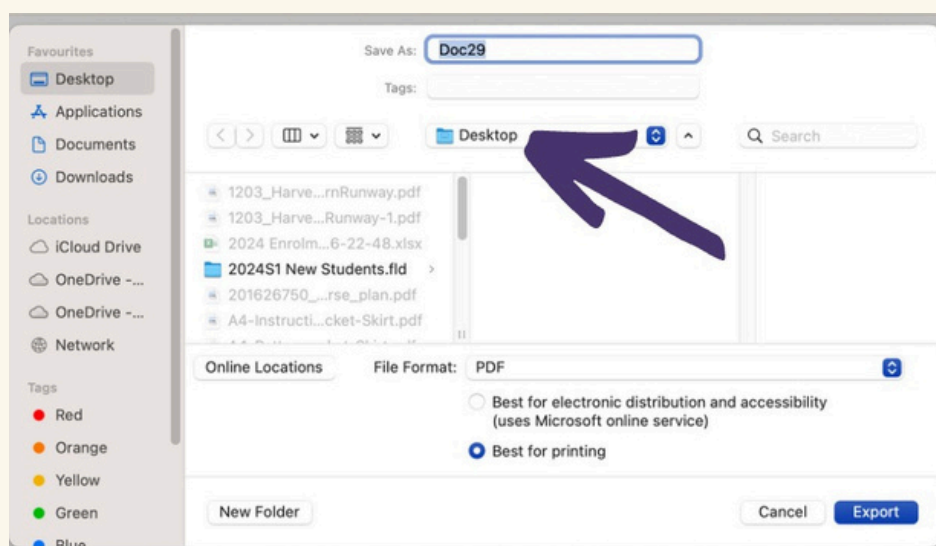
Then, where you see 'File Format:' you will notice that it currently says 'word document (.docx)'. You will need to select the arrows to the right of that.



Then, you will see a drop down menu – where you will be able to select 'PDF'

Before you hit the blue 'export' button, make sure you title your document appropriately, (see page 9), and make sure you've selected the location that your PDF will be saved.

You can do this by selecting the bar that says 'desktop' (see below picture).



How to:

SUBMIT YOUR ASSESSMENT TO ARCA

1. Locate the Assessments tab on your unit page

An orange rectangular button with a white diamond icon and the text "Assessments".

2. Select the assessment you are uploading. Click the arrow button on the right hand side.

Assignment 2

The New Testament – Historical and Theological Contexts



3. Click on the assignment submission link. Circled below.

The New Testament – Historical and Theological Contexts



Assignment 2 Notification: The New Testament – Historical and Theological Contexts



Rubric for Assignment 2



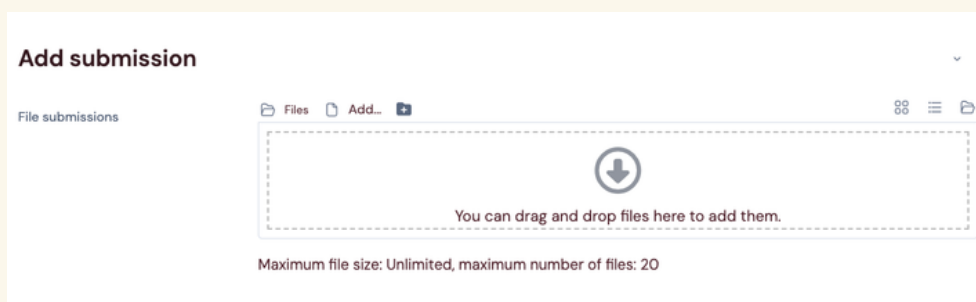
Assignment 2 – Reflective Essay

Opened: Thursday, 9 October 2025, 12:00 AM Due: Thursday, 16 October 2025, 12:00 AM

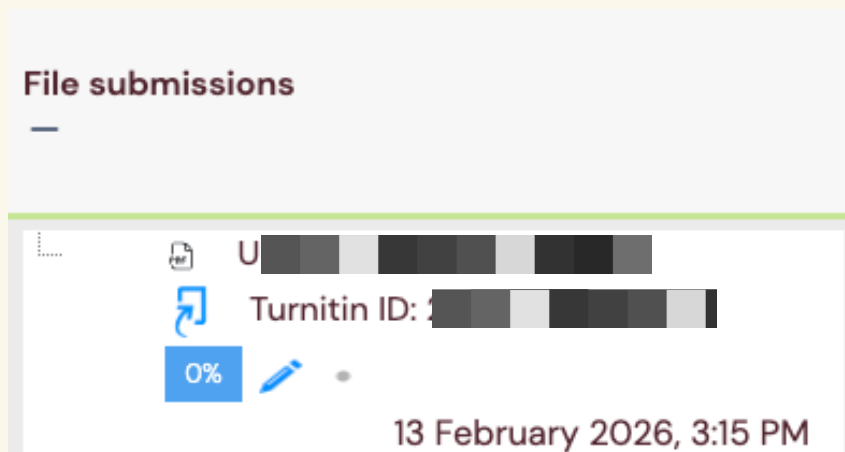
4. Click the “Add submission” button.

A dark blue rectangular button with the text "Add submission" in white.

5. Either drag your pdf assessment file to the arrow or click “File” to select your file from your computer.

The "Add submission" interface. It has a title "Add submission" and a dropdown arrow. Below is a section "File submissions" with a toolbar containing "Files", "Add...", and a plus icon. A large dashed box contains a downward arrow icon and the text "You can drag and drop files here to add them." Below this box, it says "Maximum file size: Unlimited, maximum number of files: 20".

6. Click relevant assessment declaration checkboxes and click submit.
7. You will see your submission on the next screen and receive an email notification that your assessment has been submitted.
8. Turnitin will provide you with a similarity percentage report but this can take time. Refresh your screen or come back later to check.



Remember: Your Turnitin similarity percentage can be up to 20% because of the coversheet, Bible verses etc. If it is more than 20%, check the report to see what it has flagged. If you need support, please contact your lecturer.

A Prayer for the Completion of an Assessment

Father of wisdom and understanding,
I come before You with a heart full of gratitude,
for the strength and perseverance you have granted me
in the completion of this task.

I thank You for the knowledge I have gained,
for the insights I discovered,
and for the growth I experienced through my study.

As I shut down my computer and close my books,
I offer this work to you,
knowing that it is a small reflection
of the greater wisdom you possess.

Grant me peace in my heart,
that I may rest from my work,
confident in the effort I have given.

Bless this assessment, O Lord,
that it may be a testament to Your grace.
May it be received with fairness and understanding,
and by your Spirit may it serve as a foundation
for the learning yet to come.

In Jesus' name I pray,
Amen.



**Mary Andrews
College**

A MINISTRY OF ADM

Created at Mary Andrews College for student use.
2026